



SAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Vendor Readiness Checklist

A vendor readiness package that prepares teams to engage vendors with clear scope, evaluation criteria, questions, risks, assumptions, and handoff material.

CLIENT PRIVACY

Client names and identifying details are anonymized.

DELIVERABLE TYPE

Vendor scope, readiness checklist, evaluation criteria, RFP support, questions, and handoff pack.

TYPICAL BUYER

Procurement teams, delivery leaders, technology groups, and consulting firms.



SITUATION

The team was ready to talk to vendors, but not ready to control the conversation.

Vendor engagement was approaching, but scope, assumptions, evaluation criteria, and business questions were not yet clear enough to support fair comparison or stable delivery.

PROCUREMENT ISSUE

Vendors could interpret the same need in different ways.

DELIVERY RISK

Weak handoff could lead to change requests, pricing drift, and unclear accountability.

VENDOR READINESS



Core needs are known, but scope, assumptions, and evaluation criteria need sharpening before vendor release.

READINESS CHECKS

28

Across scope, data, process, controls, and support.

VENDOR QUESTIONS

34

Grouped by domain and risk.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

12

Weighted for fair comparison.

HIGH RISK GAPS

6

Need resolution before release.

Do not release the vendor package until scope boundaries, evaluation criteria, and business acceptance measures are approved.



Vendor readiness checklist.

The checklist improves vendor comparison and reduces ambiguity before pricing and delivery commitments are made.

AREA	READINESS QUESTION	STATUS	WHY IT MATTERS
Business goal	Is the business outcome stated in measurable terms?	Ready	Vendors need the purpose, not just tasks.
Scope	Are in scope and out of scope items separated?	Needs work	Prevents pricing ambiguity.
Requirements	Are business, functional, and non functional needs documented?	Needs work	Supports comparable responses.
Data	Are source systems and data quality issues described?	Gap	Affects feasibility and integration.
Security	Are privacy, access, and data handling needs stated?	Needs work	Protects sensitive information.
Process	Is the current workflow documented?	Ready	Helps vendors understand operating fit.
Target state	Is the desired future state clear?	Needs work	Avoids solution guessing.
Evaluation	Are scoring criteria and weights approved?	Gap	Supports fair selection.
Acceptance	Are success and signoff criteria defined?	Gap	Reduces disputes after delivery.
Support	Is post implementation support expectation stated?	Needs work	Avoids hidden cost.
Timeline	Are milestone expectations realistic?	Ready	Supports delivery planning.
Commercial	Are assumptions and pricing structure requested?	Ready	Improves proposal comparison.

How this creates value

- Improves vendor response quality.
- Reduces interpretation gaps.
- Supports fair scoring.
- Protects delivery scope.

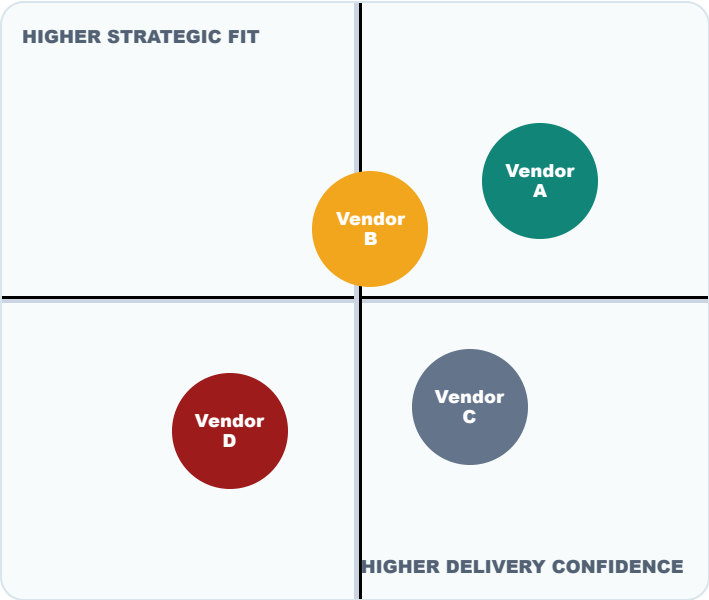
What this prevents

- Vendors pricing different scopes.
- Evaluation based on presentation polish only.
- Hidden assumptions.
- Change requests caused by weak handoff.



Vendor response quality matrix.

The matrix shows where vendor responses should be compared by value and delivery confidence.



EVALUATION AREA	WEIGHT	EVIDENCE EXPECTED
Business fit	20%	Clear link to business outcomes.
Functional fit	20%	Response maps to requirements.
Implementation approach	15%	Credible plan, roles, and timeline.
Security and controls	15%	Data, access, privacy, and audit controls.
Support model	10%	Post launch support clarity.
Commercial value	20%	Transparent pricing and assumptions.

A strong vendor package lets vendors compete on the same problem, the same evidence, and the same decision criteria.



Vendor questions and scope controls.

Good vendor questions expose assumptions before selection, not after contract award.

THEME	QUESTION	EXPECTED RESPONSE	RISK REDUCED
Scope	What assumptions are included in your estimate?	List of assumptions and exclusions.	Hidden scope.
Delivery	What client roles are required each week?	Role and effort model.	Resource surprises.
Data	What source data quality is required?	Data prerequisites and risks.	Integration delay.
Security	How will sensitive files be protected?	Security and access approach.	Privacy risk.
Acceptance	How will completion be proven?	Acceptance criteria and evidence.	Signoff dispute.
Change	How will change requests be managed?	Change process and pricing logic.	Cost drift.

Before release

- Scope boundaries
- Criteria
- Questions

During evaluation

- Scoring
- Clarifications
- Risk notes

After selection

- Assumptions
- Handoff
- Acceptance



Vendor readiness roadmap.

STEP 1

Clarify

- Business goal
- Scope boundaries
- Requirements

STEP 2

Prepare

- Questions
- Evaluation criteria
- Assumptions

STEP 3

Evaluate

- Score responses
- Compare risks
- Clarify gaps

STEP 4

Handoff

- Confirm scope
- Set acceptance
- Start governance

Decision log

DECISION	RECOMMENDATION	STATUS
Release package	Release after high risk gaps are closed.	Conditional
Evaluation weights	Approve weighted criteria before release.	Required
Clarification path	Use structured clarification log.	Approve
Contract handoff	Attach approved assumptions and acceptance criteria.	Control

Open questions

- Which requirements are mandatory?
- What vendor assumptions are unacceptable?
- Who approves scoring?
- What evidence is needed before award?

The package helps teams enter vendor conversations with clarity, control, and a fair basis for selection.